Nickson Kaigi

Software Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

- Results-driven **Full-Stack Python Engineer** with a decade of experience building **high-performance SaaS solutions** and **LLM-powered features**.
- Specialized in **LLM integration**, **database optimization**, **CI/CD pipelines**, and **API integration**.
- Adept at leading technical projects from concept to deployment using **Agile methodologies** and **cloud architecture**.

TECHNICAL EXPERTISE

Backend Python, Django, FastAPI, Django REST Framework, Celery.

AI/Data LLM integration (OpenAI, Ollama), ChromaDB, Pandas, recommender systems.

Frontend React, Next.js, jQuery (legacy).

Databases PostgreSQL, MySQL.

Cloud/DevOps AWS, Docker, Jenkins, GitHub Actions.

EXPERIENCE

Independent Technical Consultant — **Kenya – Remote**
Python / AI Engineer — *Jan 2025 – Present*

- **Recommender Systems:** Designed and built recommendation engines for client projects using Pandas and ChromaDB vector embeddings.
- **LLM Integration:** Added AI-generated summaries to existing blog platforms using OpenAI and self-hosted Ollama models.
- **Delivery:** Handled design, deployment, and CI/CD (Jenkins) end to end across short, fixed-scope contracts.

Tech Stack: Python, Django, Pandas, PostgreSQL, ChromaDB, OpenAI, Ollama, Celery, Jenkins

SKUify Limited — **United Kingdom – Remote**
Full Stack Engineer — *Dec 2023 – Dec 2024*

- **Database Optimization:** Partitioned PostgreSQL tables for high-volume datasets, reducing query latency by 30% and improving API response times by 50%.
- **Seller Analytics:** Built dashboards integrating Amazon SP-API, automating sales reports for 500+ users and enhancing decision making.
- **CI/CD:** Maintained Jenkins workflows for zero-downtime deployments, improving release efficiency by 20%.

Tech Stack: Python, Django, React, PostgreSQL, Digital Ocean, Celery, Jenkins

FreeCast Inc — **United States – Remote**
Back-end Engineer — *Sep 2022 – Nov 2023*

- **API Performance:** Migrated REST APIs from Django REST Framework to FastAPI, increasing throughput by 40% (RPS) and reducing latency.
- **Microservices Architecture:** Deployed serverless AWS Lambda endpoints with Docker, cutting infrastructure costs by 25%.
- **Agile Development:** Collaborated cross-functionally in 2-week sprints to deliver features.

Tech Stack: Python, FastAPI, Django, AWS Lambda, MySQL, Docker, GitHub Actions

Sum Software Limited **United Kingdom – Remote**
Full Stack Engineer *Nov 2021 – Jul 2022*

- **Feature Development:** Built the "Journey" component of the Sumfully SaaS, streamlining inventory management for Amazon and Arbitrage sellers.
- **Report Generation:** Developed custom Python scripts that generated report data from the SOAP-based Amazon Marketplace Web Service (MWS) API.

Tech Stack: Python, Django, Django REST Framework, React, PostgreSQL, Celery, Jenkins

World Bank Group **United States – Remote**
Technical Consultant (Contract) *Dec 2021 – Jan 2022*

- **Legal Analytics Prototype:** Developed a tool to analyze 10,000+ court judgments for bias detection using Python/Django.

Tech Stack: Python, Django, React, MySQL

Maxum Data Limited **New Zealand – Remote**
Lead Developer *Jun 2015 – Oct 2021*

- **mPort System:** Built mobile number portability tracker that facilitated seamless network operator migration for 10,000+ users.
- **Toll-Free Number Search:** Created a search tool increasing toll-free number adoption by 35%.
- **Customization:** Wrote Lua scripts for FreeSwitch, reducing network team's setup and customization time by 50%.

Tech Stack: Python, Django, MySQL, Lua

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

- **Domains Bot** – *Senior Python Engineer* Jun 2015 – Sep 2015
  Redesigned the database schema, improving query speed by 10%.
- **SunUp Financial LLC** – *Senior Python Engineer* May 2014 – Jan 2015
  Built the "Balance Credit" on-boarding flow for the company's Pay Day loans product, collaborating with the design team to enhance user experience.
- **Soko Inc.** – *Senior Python Engineer* Jul 2013 – Apr 2014
  Led development of an Android app for Soko Artisans, contributed to the REST API it consumed, and helped migrate the web project from Django to Pyramid.
- **Sweet Relish LLC** – *Senior Python Engineer* Dec 2012 – Jul 2013
  Fixed critical bugs in a jQuery Mobile application, enhancing performance.
- **Code Painters LLC** – *Lead Engineer* Sep 2012 – Nov 2012
  Led development of a gym management website with subscription management and session reservations.

- **Apartment Rentals** – *Python Engineer* Apr 2012
  Fixed bugs in the project's Django codebase.
- **MANteresting** – *Django Developer* Mar 2012 – Apr 2012
  Led development of version 1 of the REST APIs used by the mobile version of the project, following Agile methods.
- **Alliance Technologies Limited** – *Software Engineer Intern* Sep 2011 – Dec 2011
  Developed a mobile proof of concept for the A1 ERP using Java and J2ME.

EDUCATION

Jomo Kenyatta University of Agriculture and Technology **2012**
BSc Computer Science

- Second Class Honors, Upper Division.
- Coursework: Computer Programming, Data Structures and Algorithms, Database Management, Computer Security.

CERTIFICATIONS & AWARDS

Kotlin for Java Developers, Coursera. 2019